

and other sources, remove ‘dangerous’ or ‘illegal’ addresses, and/or efficiently send unsolicited (and perhaps untraceable) mail to these addresses.

Sparse Infector

Just like slow infection methods, sparse infection is also an approach to reduce the chances of early detection. The main idea is to replicate only occasionally; for example, only infecting one in every 100 programs that are executed.

Spyware

A program that gathers information and can be ‘silently’ installed and run in ‘stealth’ mode. This kind of software is used to gather information from a user’s machine, such as recorded keystrokes (passwords), a list of Web sites visited by the user, applications installed on the machine, the version of operating system, registry settings and so on.

Spyware Cookie

Any cookie that is shared among two or more unrelated sites for the purpose of gathering and sharing private user information.

Stealth Virus

Stealth viruses attempt to conceal their presence from anti-virus software. Many stealth viruses intercept disk-access requests, so when an anti-virus application tries to read files or boot sectors to find the virus, the virus feeds the program a ‘clean’ image of the requested item. Other viruses hide the actual size of an infected file and display the size of the file before infection.

Surveillance

Any software designed to use a Web cam, microphone, screen capture, or other approaches to monitor and capture information. Some such software will transmit this captured information to a remote source.